

Tickles and Treasures

Pirate story • 3-4 years old



Once upon a time, on a bright and sunny day, there was a little pirate ship named « **The Jolly Jellyfish.** » It sailed across the sparkling blue sea. The captain of the ship was a jolly man named Captain Chuckles. He had a big, floppy hat and a thick, curly beard that tickled when he laughed. Captain Chuckles loved to tell stories about treasure and adventure.

One day, as the ship bobbed on the waves, Captain Chuckles gathered his tiny crew. There were three friends: Lila, a clever girl with a bright red bandana; Benny, a brave boy with a shiny eyepatch; and their silly parrot named Polly. Polly loved to squawk funny words and jokes.

“Ahoy, crew!” Captain Chuckles called, waving his arms wide. “Today is the day we find the Lost Treasure of Ticklish Island!”

“Ticklish Island? What’s that?” asked Lila, her eyes wide with curiosity.

“It’s an island where everything is super funny!” replied Benny, giggling. “But beware! The island is guarded by Pirate Snicker, the tickliest pirate ever!”

“Ooooh! Sounds exciting!” Polly squawked. “I love tickles!”

“Alright, crew! Let’s set sail!” Captain Chuckles said, pointing to the horizon. The Jolly Jellyfish flapped its sails and drifted toward the island.

As they sailed, the sea sparkled like a million tiny stars under the sun. Lila spotted a group of dolphins leaping through the waves. “Look, everyone! Dolphins!” she shouted.

“Wow! They’re so happy!” Benny laughed, waving to the dolphins.

“They are our friends!” Captain Chuckles said. “They might help us on our journey!”

Suddenly, Polly took flight and landed on the ship’s mast. “I see something!” she squawked. “A big, funny cloud!”

“Funny cloud?” Lila asked, tilting her head. “What do you mean?”

“Look!” Polly pointed with her wing. “It’s shaped like a giant tickle!”

“Oh no! That must be the Ticklish Island!” Captain Chuckles said, squinting. “Hold on tight, crew!”

With a splash and a whoosh, they sailed right into the foggy cloud. When they emerged, there it was—Ticklish Island! It was covered in colorful trees that giggled when the wind blew.

“Wow! It’s so funny!” Benny shouted, bouncing with excitement. “Let’s find that treasure!”

“First, we need to be careful!” Captain Chuckles said. “We might run into Pirate Snicker!”

Just then, a tall pirate with a wild hairdo appeared on the beach. It was Pirate Snicker! He had a big grin and a tickly feather in his hand.

“Ahoy, little pirates!” he laughed. “You’ve come to find my treasure, haven’t you? But first, you must survive my tickle test!”

Benny stepped forward. “We’ll take your test! We’re brave!”

“Very well!” said Pirate Snicker. “Here’s how it goes. If you can make me laugh, you can pass! But if I laugh, you must try not to giggle!”

“I can do that!” Lila said confidently. “Why don’t you start?”

Pirate Snicker wiggled his feather and said, “What did the ocean say to the pirate?”

“I don’t know!” Benny replied, biting his lip to hold back a giggle.

“Nothing! It just waved!” Pirate Snicker burst out laughing.

“Oh no!” Lila squeaked, covering her mouth. “I giggled!”

“Ha! You’re out!” Pirate Snicker laughed and twirled around.

“Let me try!” Benny said, stepping up. “What do you call a pirate who skips school?”

“I don’t know!” Pirate Snicker said, trying to keep a straight face.

“A captain of the ‘class’!” Benny exclaimed, bursting into laughter.

“Very good!” Pirate Snicker chuckled, wiping a tear from his eye. “You’re still in!”

“Polly, your turn!” Captain Chuckles encouraged.

Polly hopped excitedly. “What does a parrot say when it’s confused?”

“I don’t know! What?” Pirate Snicker asked, leaning in.

“Polly wants a cracker! But I lost it!” Polly squawked.

Pirate Snicker snorted with laughter. “That was funny! But you still must try not to giggle!”

Finally, it was Captain Chuckles’ turn. He stood tall, puffing out his chest. “What did one ocean say to the other ocean?”

“I don’t know!” Pirate Snicker said, grinning.

“Nothing! They just waved!” Captain Chuckles exclaimed.

“Ha! I can’t stop laughing!” Pirate Snicker said, rolling on the sand. “You all

passed the tickle test!"

"Yay!" the crew cheered.

"Now, for the treasure!" Pirate Snicker said, wiping his eyes. "Follow me!"

They followed him deep into the giggly jungle, where flowers danced and trees whispered. Finally, they reached a sparkling cave. At the entrance, a sign read: "The Treasure of Giggles."

Inside, they found a chest filled with golden coins, shiny jewels, and lots of tickle feathers. Captain Chuckles opened the chest with a loud creak. "Look at all this! We did it!" he shouted joyfully.

"Let's share it!" Lila said. "We can buy sweets for everyone!"

"And toys!" Benny cheered.

"And more jokes!" Polly added, flapping her wings with joy.

"Ahoy, you've got the spirit of pirates!" Pirate Snicker smiled. "You've shown courage, cleverness, and kindness. Here, take some treasures with you!"

As they sailed back home on The Jolly Jellyfish, they laughed and shared jokes. The treasure wasn't just coins and jewels; it was the fun and friendship they found along the way.

"Hooray for the brave pirate crew!" Captain Chuckles cheered as the sun set, painting the sky with pink and orange.

"Adventure is the best treasure!" Lila said, smiling at her friends.

And from that day on, Captain Chuckles, Lila, Benny, and Polly went on many more adventures, always in search of laughter and friendship, because that was the greatest treasure of all.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What is the name of the pirate ship?

- The Jolly Jellyfish
- The Brave Dolphin
- The Singing Seagull
- The Happy Shark

2) Who is the captain of the ship?

- Captain Crunch
- Captain Chuckles
- Captain Hook
- Captain Silly

3) What is the name of the island they visit?

- Giggle Island
- Ticklish Island
- Treasure Island
- Funny Island

4) What does Pirate Snicker want them to do?

- Find a treasure map
- Survive a tickle test
- Make him cry
- Swim in the sea

5) What do they find in the treasure chest?

- Gold coins and jewels
- Pirate hats and swords
- Food and drinks
- Maps and compasses

Correct answers:

1) The Jolly Jellyfish 2) Captain Chuckles 3) Ticklish Island 4) Survive a tickle test 5) Gold coins and jewels

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Adventure: An exciting experience or journey, often involving risks and challenges.

Treasure: Valuable items such as gold, silver, or jewels that are hidden or sought after.

Courage: The ability to face fear or challenges bravely.

Jungle: A dense, tropical forest where many plants and animals live.

Giggle: A light and cheerful laugh.

Squawk: A loud, harsh sound made by birds, especially parrots.